

Hegel — MCQ Questions

56-question closed-book bank · no answer key

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MCQ 1

For Hegel, the dialectical method is best described as:

- A. a formal calculus that treats every contradiction as a defect in reasoning
- B. an externally imposed debate that alternates assertions with their simple denials
- C. an empirical pattern inferred from recurring stages in political and cultural history
- D. an immanent movement in which finite concepts expose, negate and overcome their own limits

MCQ 2

'Determinate negation' in Hegel means that:

- A. a definite concept's failure yields a specific successor that preserves its transformed content
- B. every denied concept dissolves into an empty nothing lacking any positive determination
- C. a thinker subjectively doubts a claim without exposing a defect within its content
- D. formal consistency requires excluding contradiction before any conceptual development can occur

MCQ 3

In Hegel's method, contradiction functions as:

- A. a terminal defect showing that the argument must return to its initial premise
- B. a verbal ambiguity removable by analysis without revising the conceptual content under examination
- C. an internal tension that drives a finite category toward a more adequate determination
- D. a projection of finite understanding onto a reality otherwise free from opposition

MCQ 4

Hegel's term *Aufhebung* (sublation) simultaneously means:

- A. cancelling a determination, preserving its truth, and raising it into a richer mediated unity
- B. rejecting a determination completely and replacing it with an unrelated category
- C. preserving a determination unchanged while adding a merely external qualification
- D. raising a determination to a higher level without cancelling any of its limits

MCQ 5

The opening triad of Hegel's Science of Logic runs:

- A. the Idea, external Nature, and self-returning Spirit
- B. a thesis, its antithesis, and their synthesis
- C. pure Being, pure Nothing, and their Becoming
- D. universality, particularity, and concrete individuality

MCQ 6

Hegel's 'concrete universal' together with 'the True is the Whole' asserts that:

- A. truth consists in independent propositions whose meanings remain fixed outside any systematic relation or wider context
- B. truth belongs only to separate particulars because an articulated whole cannot be known
- C. truth is an abstract universal purified of every differentiating and particular content
- D. truth is a developed whole whose universal meaning is articulated through particular moments

MCQ 7

In Hegel's system, Logic, Nature and Spirit correspond respectively to the Idea:

- A. Idea in itself, Idea outside itself, and Idea returned to itself
- B. Idea outside itself, Idea returned to itself, and Idea in itself, respectively
- C. Idea returned to itself, Idea in itself, and Idea outside itself
- D. Idea in itself, Idea returned to itself, and Idea outside itself

MCQ 8

Which sequence correctly orders the divisions of Hegel's philosophy of Spirit?

- A. Absolute Spirit, Objective Spirit, and Subjective Spirit, in descending order
- B. Objective Spirit, Subjective Spirit, and Absolute Spirit
- C. Subjective Spirit, Absolute Spirit, and Objective Spirit
- D. Subjective Spirit, Objective Spirit, and Absolute Spirit

MCQ 9

In Absolute Spirit, the three forms in which Spirit knows itself are:

- A. logical categories, natural forms, and historical institutions considered as system-wide domains
- B. family relations, civil society, and the constitutional state
- C. artistic intuition, religious representation, and philosophical thought
- D. sensation, perception, and the understanding of appearances

MCQ 10

The lordship-bondage dialectic begins from a struggle in which each self-consciousness seeks:

- A. secure possession of material goods supplied by the opposing consciousness
- B. complete isolation from every dependence upon another self-conscious being
- C. the opportunity to discipline the other through productive labour and service
- D. recognition of itself as an independent self-consciousness by the other

MCQ 11

In the master-slave dialectic, the bondsman advances toward independent self-consciousness through:

- A. fear of death and formative labour that gives enduring form to the worked object
- B. the lord's voluntary recognition of the bondsman as already fully independent
- C. victory over the lord in a renewed struggle that simply reverses their positions
- D. withdrawal from practical activity into the purely inward freedom of Stoicism

MCQ 12

The 'reversal' in the master-slave dialectic is that:

- A. the bondsman becomes wholly dependent because labour removes every form of self-relation
- B. the lord depends on labour and receives recognition from a consciousness he devalues
- C. both consciousnesses immediately achieve equal recognition once the struggle has ended
- D. the lord secures satisfying independence because consumption frees him from the object

MCQ 13

In the Phenomenology, Stoicism is the freedom of self-consciousness that:

- A. retreats into universal thought and claims freedom whether enthroned or enchained
- B. denies all external reality and treats every object as a private mental construction
- C. projects an unchangeable divine essence beyond an abject and divided finite self
- D. achieves reconciliation by submitting desire and work to a mediating religious authority

MCQ 14

Scepticism, as the truth of Stoicism, is characterised by Hegel as:

- A. active negation of determinate claims that contradicts its own continuing assertions
- B. serene indifference to fortune grounded in the universality of inward thought
- C. formative labour through which the dependent consciousness reshapes the objective world
- D. devotion to an Unchangeable beyond mediated by work, sacrifice, and religious authority

MCQ 15

The Unhappy Consciousness is Hegel's analysis of:

- A. an ethical community whose shared institutions reconcile individual and universal freedom
- B. a lord whose consumption has secured complete independence from dependent recognition
- C. a sceptic whose universal negation has become coherent and free of self-contradiction
- D. a divided self that places the Unchangeable beyond itself and devalues its own finite agency

MCQ 16

Hegel's dictum 'What is rational is actual and what is actual is rational' is correctly read as:

- A. every long-standing institution is rational merely because it persists and exercises an established social function
- B. no existing political or social order can be criticised by standards of reason
- C. actuality names existence that realises its concept, unlike merely present existence
- D. only conceptual structures are real, whereas events and institutions are appearances

MCQ 17

In insisting the Absolute is 'Subject, not merely Substance', Hegel chiefly corrects:

- A. Spinozist substance lacking self-mediation, development, and return through conscious Spirit itself
- B. Kantian causality limited to appearances as a correction to an inert metaphysics of substance
- C. Berkeleyan ideas ordered by God and perceived within finite immaterial spirits
- D. Fichtean opposition between the self-positing ego and a limiting non-ego within consciousness

MCQ 18

Within Hegel's Absolute Idealism, the phenomenal world is:

- A. a finite but real moment through which the self-developing Absolute manifests itself
- B. an independent thing-in-itself that remains permanently external to rational mediation
- C. a collection of private ideas contained separately within each empirical human mind
- D. an entirely unreal veil that must disappear without preservation in Absolute knowledge

MCQ 19

Hegel's core objection to Kant's unknowable thing-in-itself is that:

- A. ordinary perception directly reveals noumenal objects as they are in themselves once conceptual mediation is suspended
- B. a determinately asserted limit is already thought relationally and cannot remain wholly external
- C. the moral law supplies theoretical knowledge of the thing-in-itself as a positive object
- D. noumenal things are identical with Berkeleyan ideas perceived and coordinated by God

MCQ 20

Strawson's The Bounds of Sense converges with Hegel in holding that:

- A. pure reason can positively describe supersensible objects without conditions supplied by sensibility or understanding
- B. critical philosophy should be enlarged into a complete metaphysics of the self-knowing Absolute
- C. a supersensible cause of sensibility misuses concepts whose legitimate use is restricted to experience
- D. space and time belong to things in themselves rather than to our forms of sensible intuition

MCQ 21

The Logic-to-Nature transition - the Idea 'freely releasing itself' - is best understood as:

- A. a divine act of creation that occurs at the first moment of cosmic time
- B. a non-temporal claim that pure self-relating form determines itself as externality
- C. an efficient causal process in which logical categories physically produce matter
- D. an a priori derivation of each empirical species, planet, and contingent natural fact

MCQ 22

Hegel's phrase 'the impotence of nature' (Ohnmacht der Natur) means that:

- A. Nature achieves a more adequate rational form than Spirit because externality perfects the Concept
- B. Nature fails to embody the Concept perfectly and therefore displays contingency and irregularity
- C. Nature lacks any reality because only logical categories possess genuine philosophical being
- D. Natural science is impossible because empirical observation cannot disclose rational structures

MCQ 23

The strongest objection to the Logic-to-Nature transition, launching later existentialism, was pressed by:

- A. Trendelenburg, who argues that dialectic imports motion into otherwise static categories
- B. Feuerbach, who interprets the transition as creation theology translated into concepts
- C. Schelling, who argues that logical essence cannot generate the sheer fact of existence itself
- D. Popper, who attacks retrospective historical necessity as resistant to falsification

MCQ 24

Hegel's three great stages in the history of freedom run:

- A. all persons free, then some citizens free, then one ruler alone free
- B. some citizens free, then one ruler alone free, then all persons free
- C. one ruler alone free, then all persons free, then some citizens free in Hegel's claimed progression
- D. one ruler alone free, then some citizens free, then all persons free

MCQ 25

The 'cunning of reason' (List der Vernunft) names Hegel's idea that:

- A. world-historical individuals consciously design every stage of the rational historical process
- B. reason employs private passions as instruments for ends the agents do not themselves intend
- C. historical events arise randomly and acquire rational significance only through later narration
- D. reason deceives itself through human action and therefore never attains institutional expression

MCQ 26

Popper's criticism is most sharply aimed at Hegel's:

- A. retrospective philosophy of history that can redescribe events as necessary after they occur
- B. the Science of Logic considered solely as an invalid symbolic calculus rather than a philosophy of historical prediction
- C. the lordship-bondage episode treated as a testable prediction of immediate emancipation
- D. the three senses of Aufhebung treated as a contradiction in ordinary lexical usage

MCQ 27

The decisive contrast between Berkeley's subjective idealism and Hegel's absolute idealism is that:

- A. Berkeley treats experienced objects as ideas ordered by divine perception, while Hegel makes the Absolute a timeless perceiver of those ideas
- B. both make reality a collection of ideas privately possessed by finite spirits and coordinated by one transcendent divine mind
- C. Hegel explains ideas through God's infinite perception, while Berkeley makes nature and finite spirit moments of a dialectical whole
- D. Berkeley: ideas perceived by finite spirits and ordered in God's infinite perception; Hegel: nature and finite spirit are moments of the Absolute

MCQ 28

Marx's relation to Hegel is most accurately summarised as:

- A. retaining dialectical transformation while relocating it from the Idea to material social relations
- B. rejecting dialectical development together with every material explanation of contradiction, labour, and historical conflict

- C. accepting Hegel's idealist system while replacing only his terminology of contradiction
- D. retaining the self-developing Idea while abandoning contradiction, labour, and historical change

MCQ 29

Which statement about 'thesis-antithesis-synthesis' is correct?

- A. Hegel coined the exact formula and used it as the universal algorithm of the Logic
- B. the formula is a later shorthand associated with Fichte and Chalybaeus, not Hegel's regular schema
- C. Kant introduced the exact formula for the antinomies and Hegel adopted it without alteration
- D. the formula is a recent editorial error with no identifiable place in nineteenth-century reception

MCQ 30

The claim that 'Hegel tried to deduce the number of planets a priori' is:

- A. an accurate summary of how the Philosophy of Nature derives every astronomical detail
- B. evidence that Hegel regarded all contingent observations as deductions from pure categories
- C. a direct consequence of free release understood as an empirical theory of planetary formation
- D. a caricature, since nature's contingency blocks a priori deduction of every particular fact

MCQ 31

Regarding Popper's 'unfalsifiability' charge, the disciplined view is that it:

- A. decisively refutes every transition in the Science of Logic as an empirical prediction
- B. targets retrospective historicism strongly but fits the categorial Logic only with qualification
- C. applies equally to Hegel's logical, natural, historical, political, and cultural claims without any qualification
- D. repeats a methodological criticism that Hegel explicitly formulated and accepted himself

MCQ 32

What is the controlled point of Being–Nothing–Becoming?

- A. Nothing is a concealed physical entity encountered after the disappearance of ordinary beings
- B. pure Being and pure Nothing coincide in indeterminacy, while Becoming expresses their passage

- C. Being first exists in time and then causally produces Nothing as a second event
- D. the opening mnemonic mechanically guarantees every later category and transition without any additional immanent argument

MCQ 33

Which sequence gives the moments of the Concept (*Begriff*)?

- A. Logic, Nature, and Spirit as the main divisions of Hegel's system
- B. artistic intuition, religious representation, and philosophical comprehension
- C. universality, particularity, and individuality within one self-determining Concept
- D. an initial thesis, an opposed antithesis, and an externally composed synthesis

MCQ 34

Which verdict on Hegel's challenge to Kant is most precise?

- A. it pressures reified two-world readings, while Kant's negative-noumenon reply remains available
- B. thinking any conceptual boundary immediately proves every substantive proposition and transition claimed within Absolute Idealism
- C. Kant positively describes noumenal objects through the categories of cause and existence
- D. Hegel preserves a permanently external unknowable remainder alongside mediated experience

MCQ 35

What is Hegel's true infinite?

- A. an endless advance from one finite term to another finite term beyond it
- B. a supernatural entity separated from finite existence by an unbridgeable boundary
- C. a mediated self-relation that includes finite limitation and returns from otherness into itself
- D. the elimination of finite beings as wholly unreal appearances without determinate content

MCQ 36

How should Hegel's one–some–all history scheme be used?

- A. as a neutral contemporary taxonomy for comparing every civilisation without normative ranking, exclusion, or Eurocentric hierarchy

- B. as proof that each historical event necessarily increases freedom in an observable sequence
- C. as a substitute for explaining determinate negation and sublation in Hegel's logical method
- D. as Hegel's retrospective Eurocentric teleology, followed by criticism of exclusion and determinism

MCQ 37

Which belongs outside the printed Hegel owner except as bounded orientation?

- A. full political philosophy, aesthetics, religion, and later Marxist or analytic receptions
- B. the doctrine of Absolute Idealism and reality as a self-developing rational whole within the printed syllabus owner
- C. the 2025 challenge to Kant's distinction between phenomena and noumena
- D. determinate negation, contradiction, mediation, and the structure of sublation

MCQ 38

Consider the following statements about Hegel's post-Kantian project.

1. Hegel accepts Kant's claim that objectivity requires conceptual form.
2. Hegel treats phenomenon/noumenon and subject/object as permanently external limits.
3. Hegel tests fixed oppositions by asking whether each can be intelligible without its excluded other.
4. Hegelian reconciliation means erasing every difference between the opposed terms.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. statements 2 and 4 only
- B. statements 1, 2 and 3 only
- C. statements 1 and 3 only
- D. statements 1, 3 and 4 only

MCQ 39

A candidate claims that Hegelian contradiction licenses accepting any proposition whatever. Which response is most defensible?

- A. agree, because Hegel abandons every constraint on valid inference and conceptual succession
- B. disagree, because contradiction never appears within Hegel's account of finite categories
- C. agree, because Becoming temporally alternates between any true proposition and its negation
- D. disagree, because finite self-opposition must generate a constrained determinate successor

MCQ 40

Which inference best expresses Hegelian mediation?

- A. related terms are genuine only after each is completely defined in isolation from the other
- B. a term can truly depend on its excluded other for identity without becoming identical with it
- C. relational dependence proves that all differences between the related terms are merely unreal
- D. mediation requires an external observer to combine two otherwise complete and finished terms

MCQ 41

A finite limit is repeatedly crossed only to reveal another limit beyond it. For Hegel this most directly exemplifies

- A. bad infinity, because each crossed finite boundary merely produces another external beyond
- B. Absolute Spirit, because endless quantitative progression completes philosophical self-knowledge
- C. negative noumenon, because each new limit marks an unknowable object outside experience
- D. concrete universality, because an indefinite series organises all differences within one whole

MCQ 42

In the *Phenomenology of Spirit*, a "shape of consciousness" is overcome when

1. its object fails the shape's own criterion;
2. only the object changes while the standard remains untouched;
3. both the account of the object and the knowing standpoint are transformed;
4. an external philosopher imposes a criterion unrelated to the shape.

Which are correct?

- A. statements 1 and 3 only
- B. statements 1 and 2 only
- C. statements 2 and 4 only
- D. statements 1, 3 and 4 only

MCQ 43

Which conclusion goes beyond what Hegel's lordship–bondage episode by itself establishes?

- A. subordinate recognition cannot satisfy the lord's claim to independent self-certainty

- B. fear, service, and formative labour can transform the bondsman's practical self-relation
- C. every historical domination must quickly collapse into equal and reciprocal recognition
- D. unequal recognition is internally unstable as an account of self-conscious freedom

MCQ 44

Why does complete self-renunciation reverse into a transition toward Reason in Hegel's account?

- A. the mediator confirms that the Unchangeable must remain permanently external to finite activity, work, and self-conscious agency
- B. self-renunciation reveals universality operating through the self's own activity rather than beyond it
- C. the self abandons disciplined work and returns to the abstract inward freedom of Stoicism
- D. religious devotion removes the contradiction of Scepticism while preserving its universal negation

MCQ 45

An institution exists for centuries but systematically defeats the freedom it officially claims to realise. Which Hegelian assessment is strongest?

- A. its long duration alone establishes that it has realised a rational and necessary essence
- B. it may merely exist while lacking actuality because its social practice contradicts its rational concept
- C. its continued existence proves that rational criticism of the institution is conceptually impossible
- D. it is unreal only if no subject can perceive its operations or experience their consequences

MCQ 46

What follows most securely from Hegel's argument that a determinately thought limit is relational?

- A. crossing one conceptual limit proves every later claim of the Absolute system
- B. Kant failed to distinguish a negative limiting concept from a positively described noumenon
- C. all empirical distinctions between knowing subjects and encountered objects thereby disappear
- D. a positive unknowable remainder is unstable, though the complete system still needs further argument

MCQ 47

Match the critic to the objection.

1. Schelling — the Logic cannot generate the sheer fact that anything exists.

2. Trendelenburg — dialectical movement imports motion not derived from static categories.
3. Feuerbach — “free release” redescribes creation theology in conceptual language.
4. Popper — the category-to-existence transition is primarily a problem of retrospective historicism.

Which statements are correctly matched?

- A. statements 1 and 4 only
- B. statements 2 and 3 only
- C. all four statements: 1, 2, 3 and 4
- D. statements 1, 2 and 3 only

MCQ 48

Which sequence and interpretation best fit Hegel's Objective Spirit?

- A. subjective mind, natural externality, and art; freedom means withdrawal from social relations
- B. right, morality, and ethical life; freedom becomes concrete in differentiated institutions
- C. family, religion, and philosophy; freedom remains private conviction opposed to institutions
- D. civil society, sense-certainty, and state; freedom means absence of determinate social norms

MCQ 49

Which set is accurately attributed?

1. Kierkegaard — the system loses the existing individual.
2. Marx — dialectic must be relocated in material and social relations.
3. Popper — retrospective historical necessity risks unfalsifiable historicism.
4. Trendelenburg — the main defect is that Hegel preserves too much finite individuality.

Select the correct answer.

- A. statements 1 and 2 only
- B. all four statements: 1, 2, 3 and 4
- C. statements 3 and 4 only
- D. statements 1, 2 and 3 only

MCQ 50

Which practice is safest in a UPSC answer on Hegel?

- A. treat the Phenomenology, Logic, and philosophy of history as versions of one identical three-stage sequence with interchangeable terms
- B. quote thesis-antithesis-synthesis as Hegel's universal formula without a provenance caution
- C. identify the register, paraphrase safely, and anchor translation-sensitive claims to sections
- D. attribute later Marxist and anti-colonial uses of recognition directly to Hegel's own text

MCQ 51

Which plan most directly answers the verified 2026 Hegel question?

- A. define the Absolute as static being and substitute a detailed chronological survey of Hegel's major philosophical works
- B. contrast static being with self-developing result, trace Becoming, and map Logic-Nature-Spirit
- C. explain only political history through the one-some-all account of developing freedom
- D. reconstruct Berkeley's ideas and divine perception before briefly mentioning Absolute Idealism

MCQ 52

Which statement correctly describes Hegel PYQ ownership in the verified 2018–2026 Western Philosophy record?

- A. Hegel owns six parts because the 2026 supplement does not change earlier topic packages
- B. Hegel owns every question naming him, including all four comparison questions routed elsewhere
- C. Hegel owns seven parts; 2018 and 2024 have none, and four comparisons remain cross-links
- D. Hegel owns eight parts because the 2026 Kant comparison must be counted under both owners

MCQ 53

Why does Hegel begin the *Science of Logic* with pure Being?

- A. Pure Being is the richest category because every determinate object already exemplifies it
- B. A presuppositionless science must begin with the least determined thought, whose emptiness immediately destabilises it
- C. Sense perception first supplies Being as an empirical datum from which logical categories are abstracted
- D. Aristotle established Being as the final category, so Hegel adopts it as an historically authoritative starting point

MCQ 54

Which mapping of the *Encyclopaedia* sections is accurate?

- A. §244 defines Nature as otherness; §247 states nature's impotence; §250 freely releases the Idea
- B. §244 states nature's impotence; §247 freely releases the Idea; §250 defines Nature as otherness
- C. §244 freely releases the Idea; §247 states nature's impotence; §250 defines Nature as otherness
- D. §244 freely releases the Idea; §247 defines Nature as otherness; §250 states nature's impotence

MCQ 55

How should Hegel's lectures on the philosophy of history be used in an answer?

- A. As posthumously edited, student-mediated evidence whose formulations require explicit source caution
- B. As a book Hegel personally published and revised, carrying the same textual status as the *Science of Logic*
- C. As later Marxist reconstruction that cannot supply any evidence about Hegel's own account of history
- D. As an official transcript that fixes one uncontested wording for the progress and cunning-of-reason formulas

MCQ 56

Which sequence accurately follows Hegel's principal developmental locations and works?

- A. Nuremberg *Phenomenology* → Jena *Science of Logic* → Berlin *Encyclopaedia* → Heidelberg *Philosophy of Right*
- B. Jena *Science of Logic* → Nuremberg *Phenomenology* → Heidelberg *Philosophy of Right* → Berlin *Encyclopaedia*
- C. Jena *Phenomenology* → Nuremberg *Science of Logic* → Heidelberg *Encyclopaedia* → Berlin *Philosophy of Right*
- D. Heidelberg *Phenomenology* → Jena *Encyclopaedia* → Nuremberg *Philosophy of Right* → Berlin *Science of Logic*